Welcome to Grad School Bootcamp

Your First Step Toward Grad School Success



©UC Berkeley, BGA Program

Course Creator & Instructor: Sally Clapper





Meet your instructor, Sally Clapper

Founder of Career Compass, BGA Instructor & Course Creator (Career Development & Grad School Prep) & the Happily Landed Program

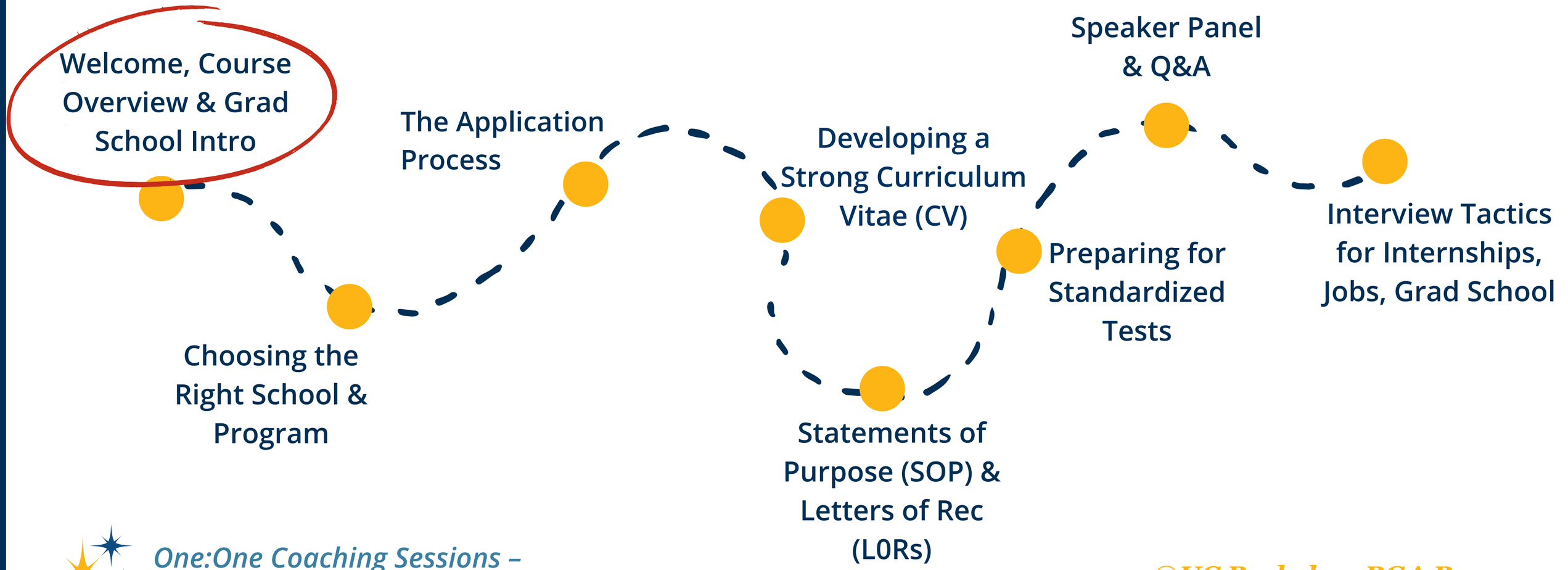
Prof. Sally and her courses are fantastic; and as a result of this and her coaching, I was much more confident in my graduate application.

She clearly taught everything, from CVs, Diversity Statements, PS, and SOPs to networking with admissions officers and professors. She was such a caring coach and there is no way I would have been accepted to my dream school if it weren't for her help!



~ Jingyue

U.S. Graduate School Prep Course



One:One Coaching Sessions – get customized, expert advice!

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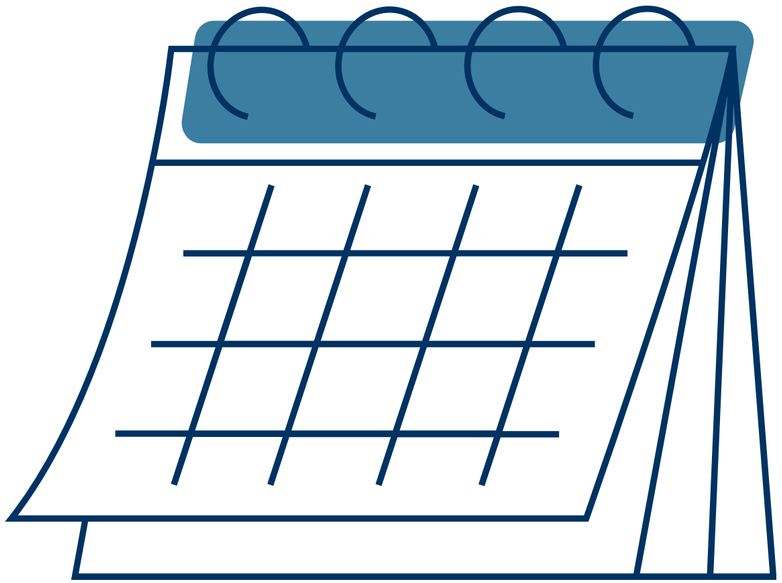
Important Info

ATTENDANCE

- Initial next to your name on the attendance sheet

Exit Card Surveys

- Name
- Date
- Question(s)



Class Dates

Thursdays, 12:30-2:30pm

9/4, 9/25, 10/2, 10/9, 10/16, 10/23, 10/30, 11/6

Last Day to Drop
Sept 19th

Important Info

GRADING

P/NP

UNITS | COURSE CREDITS

This is a 1-unit course that applies to your 12-unit minimum course requirement.



CLASSES WILL NOT BE RECORDED, YOU MUST BE PRESENT

Important Info

TRANSCRIPT

This is an Extension course and will show up in the same transcript as your other courses at the end of the semester.

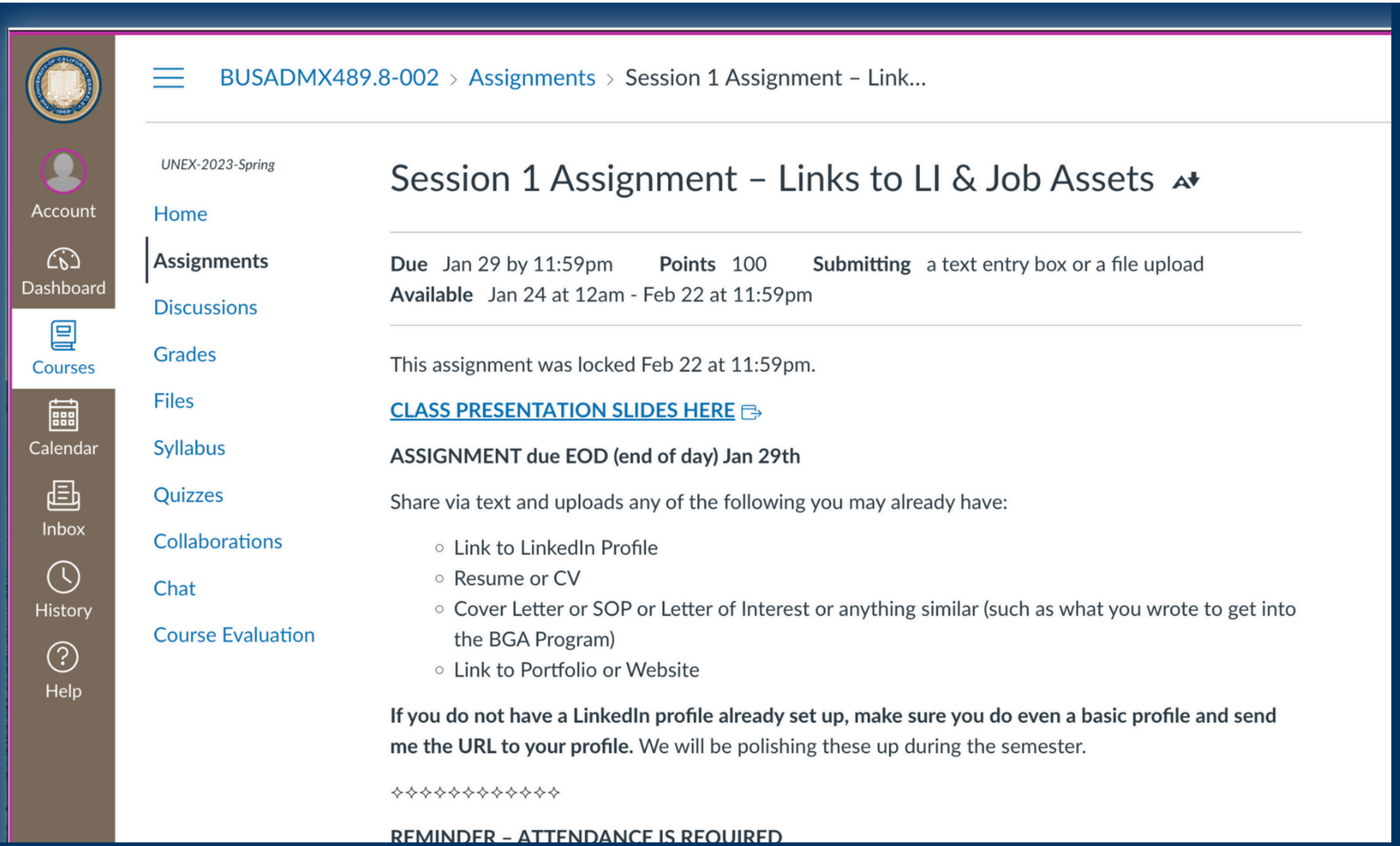
CAN YOU FIND THE COURSE ON CALCENTRAL?

No, because it is an Extension course, you must do so through the extension website. Once you sign up, you'll receive an email containing an invite to join the Canvas Course. If you think you have enrolled but do not see this in your Canvas yet, email bga@berkeley.edu to get support.

F1, OPT or I-20 Visa Info

Please contact the International Services team at extension-intl@berkeley.edu

Quick Tutorial of Canvas



Quick Tutorial of Canvas




LET'S DIVE IN

IS GRADUATE SCHOOL THE RIGHT CHOICE FOR YOU?

7 Questions to Ask Yourself...



#1 – WHAT IS YOUR MOTIVATION?

POSITIVE

- You have clear career-specific goals, such as law school or AI Research Scientist (via Computer Science)

- You have some idea of the type of degree, study, research you want to do that leads to reaching career goals

NEGATIVE

- Not sure what you want to do but academia life feels safe and comfortable

- Just following friends without clear direction



#2 – DO YOU HAVE CLEAR CAREER ASPIRATIONS & EXPECTATIONS?

- Have you done any research into the difference between academic study and the real world job?
- Do you know the job opportunities in your field?
- Are you staying up-to-date on how AI may be changing your industry?





#3
HAVE YOU DONE THE COST-BENEFIT ANALYSIS?



- Balance the cost of education with potential future income.
- Avoid unnecessary debt, especially for degrees that may not significantly impact earning potential.
- Consider regional advantages and the strength of alumni networks when choosing a program.
- Be mindful of taking on debt without a clear plan for repayment.

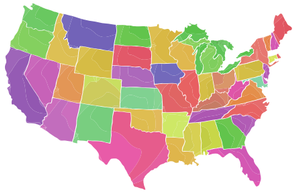
#4 – DO YOU KNOW WHICH PROGRAM IS BEST?



Masters, PhD, Speciality
(JD, EdD, MD, etc.)



Networking & Research
Opportunities



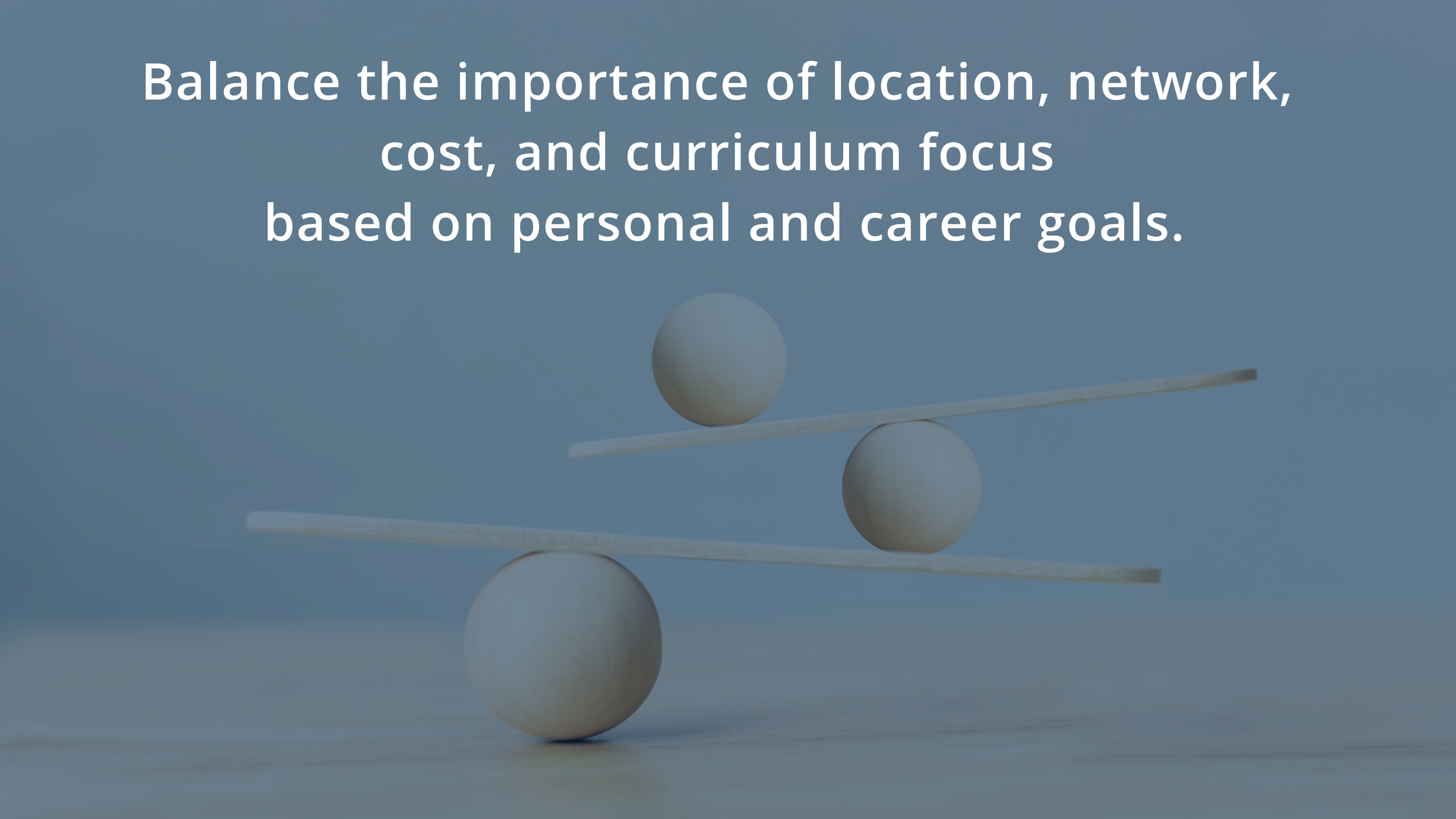
Geographic Location



Online Non-degree Courses
**preparatory step before fully committing*



Balance the importance of location, network, cost, and curriculum focus based on personal and career goals.



#5 – IS YOUR PROFILE COMPETITIVE FOR THE TOP 80 SCHOOLS IN THE US?

Aim for top 80 or max top 100 ranked schools to avoid low-quality or fake universities, but narrow down your choices.

Use Google or ChatGPT to do research on both ranking, scores and international student admission rates.

Rank	Name Country/Region	No. of FTE Students	No. of students per staff	International Students	Female:Male Ratio	% Interdiscip. Science Research
2	Stanford University United States	14,517	6.4	23%	47 : 53	22%
3	Massachusetts Institute of Technology United States	11,085	8.0	33%	41 : 59	40%
4	Harvard University United States	20,050	9.0	25%	51 : 49	12%
6	Princeton University United States	7,753	7.3	23%	47 : 53	43%
7	California Institute of Technology United States	2,240	6.1	33%	37 : 63	49%
9	University of California, Berkeley United States	39,991	17.9	22%	52 : 48	36%
10	Yale University United States	11,924	5.2	21%	51 : 49	13%

www.timeshighereducation.com

#6 – HOW GOOD ARE YOU AT FIGURING THINGS OUT?

Ambitious and driven individuals thrive, but those without clear direction or who are not comfortable networking or being competitve may struggle.



#7 – ARE YOU DETERMINED TO SETTLE OUTSIDE YOUR HOME COUNTRY?

- The H1B and green card situation can be challenging, with long wait times.
- If your main goal is to settle in the US, have a plan B since relying solely on a graduate degree might not guarantee it.
- Be open to returning to your home country or moving to another country if things don't work out in the US.

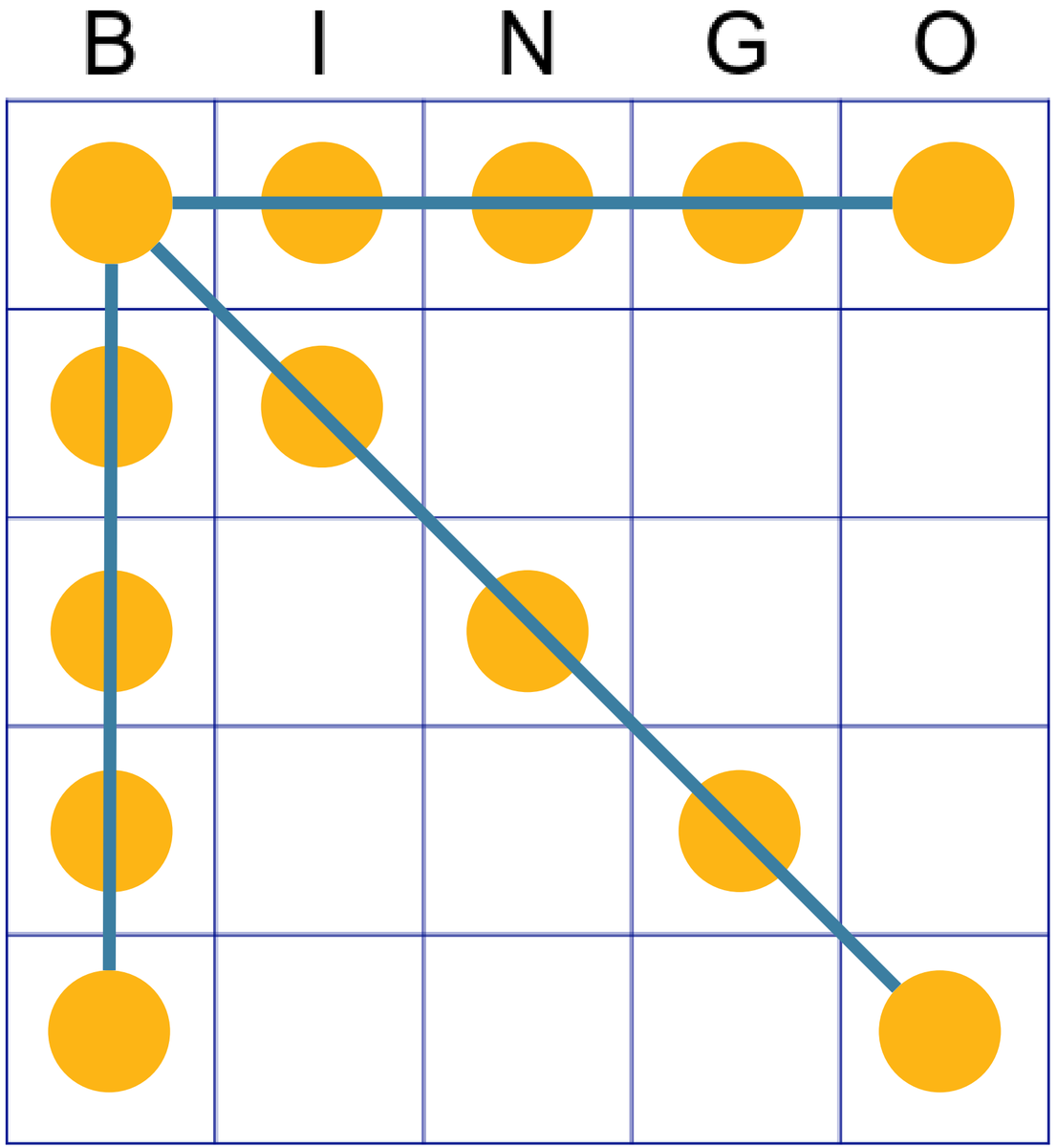



BINGO!

Goal is to get 5 across, down or diagonal
(or go for Black Out!)

RULES

- Introduce yourself first
- You cannot have the same person sign twice or just hand them your card



Quick Overview of Program Choices

MASTER'S v PhD

	Master's Program	PhD Program
Focus	Career-oriented, practical applications	Research-oriented, original contributions
Coursework	Emphasis on specific skills and knowledge	Theoretical foundation, research methodologies
Dissertation/Thesis	May require a final project or thesis	Requires original research and a dissertation
Career Opportunities	Prepares for professional roles in various industries	Opens doors to academia, research leadership, and specialized roles
Outcome	Advanced expertise in a specific field	Contribution to the existing body of knowledge

NOTE

Research Focused Masters
v
Professional Masters

COMPARATIVE OVERVIEW OF ADVANCED GRADUATE DEGREES

DEGREE	INTENT	PURPOSE	DURATION	ELIGIBILITY
MA (Master of Arts)	In-depth study in humanities or arts, social sciences	Career boost or pivot in the humanities or arts	Generally 2 years	Bachelor's
MS (Master of Science)	In-depth study in science or engineering	Career boost or pivot in science or engineering	Generally 2 years	Bachelor's
JD (Juris Doctor)	To practice law	Become a lawyer	Generally 3 years	Bachelor's
MBA (Master of Business Administration)	Advanced business and management skills	Career boost, pivot, or entrepreneurship in business	Generally 1-2 years	Bachelor's (some programs might require 2-4 years work experience)
EdS (Education Specialist)	Specialized knowledge in education beyond a master's	Advanced professional competency in a school setting	Generally 1-2 years post-master's	Master's

COMPARATIVE OVERVIEW OF ADVANCED GRADUATE DEGREES

DEGREE	INTENT	PURPOSE	DURATION	ELIGIBILITY
PhD (Doctor of Philosophy)	Hone research skills and contribute original research	Academic research, professorship, become an expert	Varies; generally 4-6 years	Master's (some programs accept directly after Bachelor's)
MD (Doctor of Medicine)	Medical practice and patient care	Become a physician or surgeon	Generally 4 years (excluding residency)	Bachelor's (often with pre-med courses)
PsyD (Doctor of Psychology)	Clinical practice in psychology	Practicing clinical psychologist	Generally 4-6 years	Master's (some programs accept directly after Bachelor's)
EdD (Doctor of Education)	Advanced professional practice in education	Leadership roles in educational settings	Generally 3-5 years	Master's

NOTES:

- International Students applying to the US are also required to take English Profeciency Tests, such as TOEFL, for all degrees listed above.
- Requirements can vary based on the country, university, and the particular program. Always consult the specific program's requirements and details for the most accurate information.

Contact Info

BMAIL

sallyclapper@berkeley.edu

Connect with Me

www.linkedin.com/in/sallyclapper

Next Class

Thurs. Sept 25th

12:30pm - 2:30pm

Your 1st Assignments
(upload via Canvas)

Assignment 1a: Due Wed., Sept 10th

- Start of Semester Survey
- Complete survey THEN leave a comment on Canvas “survey completed”

Assignment 1b: Due Wed., Sept 17th

- Read my AI use policy and leave a quick response on Canvas

Q & A

Assignment 1a

Start of Semester Survey

